

✅ **Short answer: It's very easy — especially if they use the recommended path.**

You do **not** need to rewrite everything. The whole Kerekes Handshake system was designed to be simple, and Windows support is straightforward in 2026.

1. Wrangler (Cloudflare deployment tool) → Works natively on Windows

Yes — **Wrangler is officially supported on Windows 11.**

You install it exactly the same way as on Mac/Linux:

```
PowerShell  
  
npm install -g wrangler
```

Then `wrangler deploy` works out of the box. No extra steps needed.

2. The `.sh` file (`seal-and-deploy.sh`) → Does not run natively

Windows Command Prompt / PowerShell cannot run `.sh` files directly (they are Linux/macOS shell scripts).

However, there are two dead-simple ways to make it work:

Recommended Path (Easiest for non-technical users): Use WSL2 (Windows Subsystem for Linux)

This is what I recommend for new grads or anyone on Windows.

- Takes **5–10 minutes** one-time setup.
- After that, the **exact same** `seal-and-deploy.sh` **file** runs 100% unchanged.
- You get real Linux tools (`pdftotext` , `sha256sum` , `gpg` , etc.) inside Windows.

Steps for a Windows user:

1. Open PowerShell as Administrator and run:

```
PowerShell  
wsl --install
```

(It will install Ubuntu automatically and reboot once.)

2. Open the new "Ubuntu" app that appears.
3. Inside Ubuntu, run these three commands:

```
Bash  
  
sudo apt update && sudo apt upgrade -y  
sudo apt install poppler-utils gnupg -y
```

4. Navigate to your project folder (it appears as `/mnt/c/Users/YourName/your-website/`).
5. Run the script exactly as on Linux:

```
Bash  
  
chmod +x seal-and-deploy.sh  
./seal-and-deploy.sh
```

That's it. Everything (pdftotext sidecars, manifest, PGP signing, wrangler deploy) works exactly as written.

Alternative Pure-Windows Path (No WSL)

If they really don't want WSL:

- Install **Git for Windows** → gives you "Git Bash" (a real bash shell).
- Install **Gpg4win** for PGP signing.
- Install **Poppler for Windows** (or use Chocolatey: `choco install poppler`).
- Run `seal-and-deploy.sh` inside **Git Bash** (right-click in folder → "Git Bash Here").

This works, but WSL is cleaner and more reliable for the full script.

Bottom line for new grads

- **With WSL2:** 5–10 minute setup → then they follow the exact same instructions as everyone else.
- **Without WSL:** Slightly more fiddly but still doable in <30 minutes.

Would you like me to create a “**Windows Quick-Start Guide**” (one-page instructions) that you can add to the repo or link in your posts? I can make it beginner-friendly with screenshots and exact commands.

Just say the word and I’ll give you the full copy-paste version.